990,000,000 Eligible Voters vs. The Thin Signal

Gallup World Poll

~1,000 to 3,000 respondents for all of 28 states.

V-Dem Institute

Subjective expert questionnaires. 0 citizens surveyed.

Domestic Surveys

Rigorous, but episodic every 5 years across ~190 seats.

Look at the global report cards that rank India’s happiness below active war zones. The World Happiness Report relies on Gallup data: roughly one to three thousand respondents across a nation of 990 million eligible electors. Even with face-to-face sampling, that means hundreds of Lok Sabha constituencies receive zero representation. Other democracy indices don’t survey citizens at all; they rely on subjective questionnaires filled out by handfuls of external academic panelists. Thin samples get wrapped in academic rubrics, and within hours, they become "the undisputed truth" of Bharat from London to Washington.

Even our best domestic academic surveys only sample a fraction of seats once every five years (e.g., Lokniti-CSDS NES 2024: 19,663 post-poll respondents across 191 of 543 seats - about 100 per seat). Good science, but episodic. Nothing daily, nothing for every seat.